We hesitate to recommend specific editors because we've used only a few in earnest, and we'll undoubtedly leave someone's favorite editor off the list. Nevertheless, to help you get started with something other than Notepad, here are some suggestions:

- Visual Studio Code is a free editor built on open source that runs everywhere.[30] It's a good choice for Windows, macOS, and Linux. It has a large number of extensions available, including a Ruby extension that provides syntax highlighting, code completion, and debugging support. It's the most popular choice among Rails developers at the time of this writing.

- rails.vim is a Vim/NeoVim plugin for editing Ruby on Rails applications.[31]

- RubyMine is a commercial IDE for Ruby and is available for free to qualified educational and open-source projects.[32] It runs on Windows, macOS, and Linux.

- Zed is a next-generation code editor designed for high-performance collaboration with humans and AI. It is not yet available for Windows, but it is for macOS and Linux.[33]

Ask experienced developers who use your kind of operating system which editor they use. Spend a week or so trying alternatives before settling in.

The Desktop

We're not going to tell you how to organize your desktop while working with Rails, but we'll describe what we do.

Most of the time, we're writing code, running tests, and poking at an application in a browser. So, our main development desktop has an editor window and a browser window that are permanently open. We also want to keep an eye on the logging that's generated by the application, so we keep a